



Umut Eren Demirci

Game Designer — Systems · Levels · Progression

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Portfolio: umuterdemirci.github.io

Game designer coming to games from twelve years of teaching English and designing courses, with a background in linguistics. I design difficulty curves, progression and systems that players can read at a glance, and I check them with data: for my mobile puzzle game **Arcana Match** I built a bot that plays the real game rules and used it to tune level difficulty. I work in Unity and Unreal Engine 5 (Blueprints), Excel and design documents.

Projects

Arcana Match · tarot match-3 for mobile · Unity 6 · play: ueren.itch.io/arcana-match 2026 · personal project

- Designed the whole game: an 8x8 board with five chaining special tiles, three boosters, a formula-driven level curve, and a 78-card collection with foil editions and a daily draw that has no streak to lose.
- Built a balance simulator: a bot that plays the shipped rules, 60 games per level. It showed late levels stalling at a 33–42% win rate; a sweep of goal-tile spawn weights picked 1.4x, lifting level 18 from 33% to 85% while keeping foil wins clearly harder.
- Documented it like a studio project: 18-page GDD, nine flowcharts, balance workbooks with live formulas. The card catalogue exposed a reward-pacing flaw, which I documented with a fix.
- Implemented with an AI coding assistant (Claude): I set the rules, tuning and feel, and play-tested each of six build phases. 106 automated rule tests; Android and mobile web builds for playtesters.

The Chronicles of Demise · narrative RPG concept · Unreal Engine 5 May 2025 – present · personal project

- Prototyped emotion-driven movement in Blueprints: trigger zones switch the character between Neutral, Anxious and Determined states, changing walk speed (500 / 150 / 800), braking and screen saturation, so the player feels the character's state instead of reading about it.
- Designed *The Temple of Vesta*, a level built around a "Trial of Slowness" that punishes rushing, and a "hard magic" system where spells cost health or gold.
- Adapting my own fantasy novel series, written since 2013 (100,000-word first book), into a game; built a painterly look test with an anisotropic Kuwahara filter.

Tabletop RPG design · D&D 5e modules and world-building Dec 2022 – May 2024

- Wrote and ran adventure modules, adjusting encounters, pacing and rewards from what happened at the table.

Experience

Independent game development May 2025 – present

- Portfolio work on the two projects above while moving into game design; full-time since January 2026.

Private English Tutor · self-employed, Ankara Jan 2024 – Jan 2026

- Planned one-to-one courses around each learner's level and goals, adjusting pace and difficulty lesson by lesson.

Visa and Education Consultant · TEOL and Bilimevi, Ankara (alongside teaching) 2023 – 2025

- Guided clients through visa and study-abroad applications, from first meeting to decision.

English Teacher and Course Designer · language schools and companies, Ankara 2014 – Dec 2023

- Taught English to groups and corporate clients for nine years, designing courses that introduce one new skill at a time on a rising difficulty curve and adjusting the pace from learners' results.

Skills

Design Systems and balancing · difficulty curves and level pacing · progression and meta · economy design · narrative design · GDDs and flowcharts

Tools Unity 6 · Unreal Engine 5 Blueprints · Excel (formulas, charts, simulation data) · Mermaid / draw.io · Git

Languages Turkish (native) · English (fluent)

Education

Ankara University · Linguistics (2017–2021); English Language and Literature (2013–2018) coursework, no degree